



MONTHLY UPDATE

Cote d'Ivoire: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 • 49 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA

Summary of the month

Registry and connectivity work reached places rather than announcements. The civil-registry agency handed 283 birth-registration terminals to health workers in the Tonkpi region and opened an agency inside a Yopougon shopping centre, while the rural connectivity programme commissioned its first phase at Djebakaha and launched two more, against a target of 575 localities.

Money and institutions moved with them. The government authorised a United States technology firm to run a US\$170m digital-infrastructure programme, with no contract, component list or timetable held; a five-year telecommunications and digital-infrastructure memorandum with an Indian company was executed on 19 August; the space agency gained its inaugural director general; and the universal-access agency published a strategic plan for 2026-2030.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The draft cyber-security strategy for 2026 to 2030 was put to stakeholder review on 23 July and awaits the Council of Ministers; the 2021 to 2025 text remains the instrument formally in force. The draft extends scope to artificial intelligence, emerging technologies and cloud.

The universal-service agency published its own five-year plan on 11 August. It rests on four pillars — universal connectivity, digital services and financial inclusion, digital usage and literacy, and operational excellence — across ten projects, four of them funded at FCFA 60.144bn through the national development plan and six from the agency's own funds. The stated targets are 300 newly connected localities, smartphone penetration of 80% by 2028 against 40% now, and more than 15,000 km of new fibre by 2028, against a starting point at which 70% of rural households have no internet access. No adoption instrument is published; the plan is the agency's own.

The space agency got its first head more than a year after the decree that created it. The government appointed an inaugural Director General of the Space Agency, a public administrative institution of a scientific and technological character under the higher education ministry with programme areas spanning Earth observation, space meteorology, astronomy, satellite navigation and satellite communications; the appointment date is not stated.

Legislation and regulation

The cyber-security agency is [operating a national security operations centre, a public-administration security-officer network, the national public key infrastructure and auditor certification against the state reference framework](#), resting on the 2013 electronic transactions law whose 2014 and 2016 implementing decrees are the stated legal basis for that infrastructure — the only Ivorian digital statute the base can name implementing decrees for. Against that, [no Ivorian artificial-intelligence statute is published](#): governance runs entirely through non-binding strategy instruments, with the draft cybersecurity strategy the only binding-track vehicle extending state scope to it.

The one place where a statute is acquiring machinery is consumer redress. The regulator [consulted operators, internet service providers and consumer associations on 13 and 14 August on a draft procedure for handling consumer complaints about electronic communications services](#), implementing the 2024 electronic communications law. No draft text, adoption date or redress standard is held.

The regulator [validated a harmonised procedure for handling consumer complaints](#) against operators and internet service providers, now to be transmitted to its Conseil de regulation for possible adoption.

Regional collaboration

Côte d'Ivoire is standing for a seat at the table that writes the rules. It [declared its candidacy for election to the ITU Council and will press it at the 7th World Telecommunication/ICT Policy Forum in Nassau](#), with a delegation [attending the forum to prepare that candidacy](#). The record held names no platform the candidacy would run on and no other state's support for it.

Standards

Migration data was the month's standards work, and it is regional. Two workshops [ran at Abidjan from 18 to 22 August on harmonising migration and macroeconomic data across the regional bloc](#). A national migration data governance strategy [was named by the diaspora directorate at a profiling workshop](#), but no text, timetable or adopting instrument is held for it.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The month's one entry here is research rather than an instrument. A study [documented cyclical online gendered violence against election candidates in this country and one other](#). No regulatory response, platform obligation or reporting route stands against it on the ledger.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

The month's one agreement is continental in scope and carries no money. An Ivorian mobile operator, an Indian technology company and a continental investment council [signed a five-year memorandum of agreement dated 7 August 2026 and fully executed on 19 August, covering national fibre backbones, 4G and 5G, submarine cable landing stations, internet exchange points, telecom towers, and digital identity, national interoperability, e-government and digital payment platforms](#). No financial commitment is disclosed and no Ivorian project, site or timetable is named; the memorandum is known only from the Indian party's regulatory filing.

New investments

The month's one new financing commitment is large and thinly documented. The government has [authorised a United States technology firm to carry out a set of projects strengthening national digital infrastructure, the whole estimated at US\\$170m, about FCFA 95bn](#). No signed contract, financing instrument, component list, timetable or procurement route is held for it, and it [sits beside the same firm's US\\$170m data-centre and border-surveillance package announced from Washington in July](#), which the record does not distinguish from it.

The African Development Bank's e-government programme is meanwhile the [route by which several of the ministry's digital projects reach the market, through open tenders and calls for expressions of interest](#), with the winners of the two 30-company support programmes among the intended bidders. No award, value or project list is published.

A further figure was attached to the digitalisation programme at the prioritisation workshop: [US\\$150m, about FCFA 88.5bn, stated as lender support for digitalising public services, against a state informatics company count of 315 services already digitalised](#). It was stated at a workshop rather than in a financing instrument, and its relationship to the inclusive-digitalisation credit already ratified by decree is not explained — two figures for the same donor and the same purpose, with no statement of whether they are one commitment or two.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

A low-orbit satellite operator [went live by 17 July](#) at XOF 28,746 a month for residential service, with hardware from XOF 148,148, on a twelve-month provisional licence reviewable on service quality. On 31 July the minister said regional satellite capacity would be routed through the universal-service bodies, with a working session on terms due the following week; no terms, tariff or timetable was stated. No 5G launch occurred against the announced July 2026 date. Ministry figures given on 13 July put telecommunications penetration above 130% of population and [about 38,000 km of optical fibre](#).

On protecting what is already laid, an operator and its vendor [completed a proof of concept in Abidjan that detects vibrations around fibre ducts and classifies them to flag third-party excavation before a cut happens](#), on trials run since 2025. The account is vendor-issued and states no commercial deployment, coverage or date. The cable that carries much of the traffic had already failed and been mended: the [2Africa branch into the country came back into service on 2 August after repairs](#), with WACS repairs expected the week after. Neither the outage's start nor its cause is stated.

An industry survey supplied a fact the base did not hold: 5G has run on re-allocated existing frequencies since a [provisional allocation of 19 December 2023](#), which let the two largest operators offer the service for the 2024 Cup of Nations, and it reached 7 per cent of the population in 2025, used first for fixed broadband where there is no fibre. The definitive spectrum award and the commercial launch announced for July 2026 are still undelivered, so the two things the base had run together are now separable.

The rural programme's own account reached the base for the first time. Its [first phase is complete, commissioned at Djebakaha in Korhogo, with phases two and three launched alongside it - the second valued at FCFA 18bn and covering 240 further localities across Belier, Poro, Tchologo, Bagoue and Haut-Sassandra, against a programme target of 575 localities](#). The account dates that commissioning to August 2024 while reporting it as current, so the phase chronology is not relied on here; no site count, service specification or subscriber figure is published for the completed phase.

Data Storage

The financing behind the sovereign data centre is now on the record, and it is a fraction of the project. The United States export credit agency [approved a guarantee of US\\$66,138,119 on 21 August 2025, with the finance and budget ministry as borrower and the digital transition ministry as end user](#), against the US\$170m the government authorised in July 2026. It is known from the agency's own board minutes rather than from a signed facility, and nothing published explains how the rest of the authorised cost is to be met.

Cybersecurity

The national cybersecurity agency [certified the country's first cohort of RGSSI information-security auditors and is opening two cybersecurity masters degrees](#) through its training centre, against a stated national shortfall of 2,000 cybersecurity professionals. Neither the cohort size nor the intake is given, so the gap can be stated and the progress against it cannot.

DPI

Data Exchange

The minister told an information-systems seminar on 21 and 22 July that the first services onto the interoperability platform [had been chosen largely by volunteering rather than against user priorities](#), against targets of 100 services online by end-2026 and 700 within three years. No count of services in production has been published. Fourteen migration bodies met on 30 July to [co-design a single collection and profiling tool for returning migrants](#) and a roadmap for transferring their data into one directorate; no legal basis, data-protection safeguard or timetable for pooling personal data across fourteen bodies is stated.

The country's largest working data exchange is agricultural, and its pilot met its users in August. Producers at Meagui [pressed the coffee and cocoa board on 11 August over rollout gaps in the national cocoa traceability system](#) — the conditions attached to the producer card, collection in remote zones, deceased and expired cardholders, and bank fees tied to the card. The regional delegate said pilot-phase issues are feeding refinements. No enrolment count, coverage figure, data-controller arrangement or fee schedule for the card is held. The board for the cashew sector began the same sequence a step earlier, [launching a producer and plantation census at Korhogo on 11 August](#) as the database that any producer card or traceability system would have to stand on; no timetable or budget for it is stated. Across the border, Mali's customs administration told a Bamako roundtable that its [interconnection with Ivorian customs has a transit-goods data pilot running](#); the account is Mali's, no Ivorian statement is held, and no completion date for the full interconnection is given.

Digital Payments and Fintech

A private schools federation signed a convention on 21 July putting fee collection onto mobile money in a 200-school pilot from August. The flat FCFA 100 agency fee levied on every mobile-money counter transaction since November 2025 was [documented on 24 July](#) as authorised by no operator tariff and no regulator, regressive by construction on small transfers.

Registries

Civil-registry software is [installed with hardware in every municipal and sub-prefecture civil-status centre for digital recording of births, marriages and deaths, financed by the European Union](#). Supervision is assigned to sub-prefects rather than to registrars, and the reform is framed as anti-fraud rather than as access.

The identification office marked African Civil Registration Day by putting figures and hardware behind the access side of it. The national civil-status system now [covers 699 centres and has digitised more than four million records, and on 11 August the office handed 283 digital birth-registration terminals to health workers in the Tonkpi region](#) to link maternities directly to civil-registry offices, under a programme it calls zero invisible child. The counts are the office's own, and no registration-rate outcome is attached to them.

Sectoral management information systems

Work began on digitising the national school map, education-sector stakeholders convening at Yamoussoukro on 19 August 2026 to [build geographic information systems onto the integrated education management information system](#). No coverage, timetable or delivery date is on file.

Four days into the invoicing checks the traders' federation answered with an institution rather than a boycott, [creating a National Observatory on Electronic Standardised Invoicing, announced at a press conference in Adjamé on 5 September](#). The observatory has no published mandate, membership or reporting arrangement, and the federation's earlier demand that the checks be suspended is not withdrawn on the record — so the position is opposition converted into a channel, not resolved.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

All 39 first-instance tribunals were [connected to the justice platform on 29 June 2026](#), completing an arc that began with a two-court pilot in January 2025; nationality certificates and criminal-record extracts are now issued digitally nationwide. The account describes this as completing phase one, with no phase-two scope or date. The regulator's compliance platform [went live on 2 July 2026](#), slipping from a 25 June date, replacing about a hundred physical files a month with online submission, real-time tracking and traceability for conformity, processing authorisations and video-surveillance authorisations. It was built over two years and piloted by the identification office and the treasury.

August turned to the supply side and to the state's own paperwork. The ministry [launched Ivoire GovTech Lab on 29 July, publishing government digitalisation projects for direct bidding by start-ups and small firms](#), opened applications for two 30-company support programmes, and set out a 2026-2028 roadmap naming artificial-intelligence adoption among seven strategic pillars; no project list, budget or award record for the lab is published. Separately the electronic-signature programme run by the public service ministry, which already covers the civil service, the tax administration and the construction and mining ministries, [reached the commerce ministry, whose leadership began enrolling on 12 August](#). No certificate authority, standard, enrolment total or statement of legal effect is held for it.

September gave the programme a shortlist. A national prioritisation workshop closed on 4 September having [examined 140 of 620 inventoried public services through nine working groups and retained 59 for immediate priority, with ten quick wins expected by the end of 2026 — among them diploma authentication, digital proof of life for pensioners, the computerised patient record and a digital post box](#). The list is not published, and the minister put a governance framework for the digital transition ahead of it as the first priority, against ministries each building [their own tools and platforms](#); no such framework is on the record.

The prioritisation workshop's second day produced something more consequential than the list. The nine working groups, sitting on different sectors, [converged on the same diagnosis — procedures still largely manual — and on the same answer: shared public infrastructure rather than nine separate builds, with a national single sign-on tied to the population register and the national identification number, 47 of the 49 bodies invited attending](#). That is a design decision arrived at by the departments who would have to use it, which is a different thing from one imposed on them.

Technology

AI

The meteorological agency [signed a memorandum with China's meteorological administration at Shanghai](#). It is a cooperation instrument rather than a system: no scope, model, data-sharing term or duration is published.

Innovation ecosystem

The ministry [launched two accelerator cohorts and a state procurement platform on 29 July](#), fifteen startups and fifteen digital small firms each accompanied for 24 months, applications closing 13 September, against a target of FCFA 5 to 10bn mobilised from banks, funds and donors.

A ten-year-old marketplace restructured on 31 August: the company [split its consumer and business activities and relaunched the consumer brand as Afrikrea, selling fashion, art and crafts internationally for African and diaspora creators with payment and delivery handled by the platform](#). No merchant count, transaction volume or revenue figure is published, and the terms of the split are not stated.

Capacity

Training and skills

The civil-service digital-skills programme [closed its thirteenth edition on 29 July](#), training 192 officials from about thirty public bodies over 40 days, against a cumulative claim of more than 37,500 civil servants funded from the ministry's own budget line.

Outside the service, a German-funded accelerator closed a three-month cohort on 4 August, [closing with 51 artificial-intelligence projects across finance, health, law, education and cybersecurity](#). The project count is the only measure published: participant numbers, cost and what becomes of the projects after the demonstration day are not stated, and a project shown at one is not a deployed system.

Research institutions

The cyber agency and a technology school validated curricula for two cyber-security master's degrees on 28 July, with enrolment stated for the September 2026 academic year and no intake size or funding published.

Inclusion

Access to services

Access moved by putting the counter where people already are. The civil-registry agency [opened an office inside a Yopougon shopping centre on 14 August](#). It is one site, with no opening hours, service list or plan for further locations published.

Data

Use of satellite data

The national meteorological agency [signed a convention on 10 August with a private company combining artificial intelligence, satellite data, drones and georeferenced data to monitor farm holdings and anticipate weather-linked risk](#). It is an agreement to develop solutions rather than a service: no product, value, timetable or user is named, and it is the second such convention the agency has signed this year.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-08
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/CIV/CIV-monthly.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/CIV/CIV-monthly-2026-09-08.pdf
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